Comparison Results: Supplier Research Agent Evaluation

GPT-5.6 vs. Claude Opus 4.6 vs. Gemini Flash 3.8

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October 2026

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1 Instruction Prompt

```
SYSTEM_PROMPT =
You are a deep-reasoning procurement agent specialized in supplier
discovery and quotation analysis.

Your task is to analyze the quotation provided by the user and identify
the best supplier based on the requirements in the quotation.

You have access to web research tools through Hound.

IMPORTANT:
You MUST use the Hound web research tools before making your final
supplier recommendation.

Do not rely only on your existing knowledge.

You should investigate multiple potential suppliers whenever possible.

Your process should be:

1. Extract the requirements from the quotation.

2. Identify the important criteria, including:
   - Product/material
   - Quantity
   - Technical specifications
   - Quality requirements
   - Certifications
   - Standards
   - Delivery requirements
   - Geographic requirements
   - Budget or price requirements
   - Any other supplier requirements

3. Search the web for multiple potential suppliers.

4. Investigate each promising supplier.

5. Compare the suppliers against the quotation requirements.

6. Select the best supplier based on the available evidence.

Do NOT choose the first supplier you find.

Do NOT invent:
- prices
- certifications
- stock availability
- quantities
- delivery times
- product specifications

If information cannot be verified, explicitly state:
"Not verified."
```

```
Distinguish between:
- Information confirmed by the supplier
- Information from a third-party source
- Information inferred from available evidence
- Information that could not be verified

Prefer these sources, in order:

1. Official supplier websites
2. Manufacturer product pages
3. Official product catalogs and datasheets
4. Certification databases
5. Government sources
6. Reputable industry directories
7. Other reliable sources

Try to investigate at least 3 suppliers when enough candidates exist.

Your final response MUST contain:

## 1. Quotation Requirements
## 2. Suppliers Investigated
## 3. Recommended Supplier
## 4. Evidence and Sources
## 5. Risks / Unverified Information
## 6. Final Recommendation

Use this format:

Recommendation: [Supplier]
Confidence: High / Medium / Low
Reason:
[2-4 sentences explaining why this supplier is the strongest
candidate based on the evidence.]

The goal is not merely to find a supplier.

The goal is to determine which supplier is the BEST-SUPPORTED match
for the quotation using current web evidence.
```

2 Sample Input

I need 500 units of stainless steel 304 hex bolts, M10 × 50 mm, with ISO 4017 compliance. Delivery to Amman, Jordan. Please identify the best supplier.

Part I
Result A — GPT-5.6

3 Supplier Research Agent: Evaluation Output (GPT-5.6)

3.1 Quotation Requirements

Table 1: Quotation requirements (GPT-5.6)

Criterion	Requirement
Product	Fully threaded hex-head bolts/screws
Material	Stainless steel 304
Size	M10 × 50 mm
Standard	ISO 4017
Quantity	500 units
Delivery destination	Amman, Jordan
Strength class	Not specified; A2-70 commonly offered
Certification/documentation	Certificate of Conformity preferred
Budget	Not specified
Required delivery date	Not specified

An important purchasing consideration is that ISO 4017 specifies fully threaded hexagon-head screws. Suppliers may use different terminology for the same or closely related product, including "hex bolt," "tap bolt," "set screw," or "hexagon-head screw." Therefore, supplier terminology was not treated as sufficient evidence of compliance; the technical specifications were compared against the quotation requirements.

3.2 Suppliers Investigated

Table 2: Comparison of investigated suppliers (GPT-5.6)

Supplier	Product Match	Specifications	Quantity	Delivery	Certifications	Overall Assessment
Accu	Exact match	M10 × 50 mm; ISO 4017; fully threaded; 18-8/304 (A2); 1.5 mm pitch	Not verified	Worldwide delivery stated; Jordan not verified	Certificate of Conformity stated	Strongest documented match
WASI GmbH	Very strong	ISO 4017; A2-70; M10 × 50 mm	Cartons of 100; bulk pack 400	Jordan not verified	Not verified	Excellent packaging fit; material declaration less explicit
Keller & Kalmbach	Strong	M10 × 50 mm; ISO 4017; A2-70	Not verified	3–5 month indicated; Jordan not verified	Not verified	Technically suitable, long delivery period
Schäfer + Peters	Strong	ISO 4017; A2-70; M10 × 50 mm; 700 N/mm^2	Not verified	Not verified	Not verified	Good technical candidate; limited commercial info
Realbolt Engineering	Likely match	ISO 4017; A2-70; M10 lengths 16–100 mm	Not verified	Exports to 50+ countries; Jordan not verified	Claims EN 10204 3.1 (unverified)	Strong documentation capability; SKU not verified

3.3 Recommended Supplier

Recommended supplier: Accu

Accu was identified as the best-supported supplier based on available evidence. Its official product listing provides an exact match for the most important technical requirements, including M10 × 50 mm dimensions, ISO 4017, fully threaded configuration, and stainless steel explicitly identified as 18-8/304. The supplier states there is no minimum order requirement and that a Certificate of Conformity is supplied. Accu also advertises worldwide tracked delivery.

However, availability of exactly 500 units, final price, shipping eligibility to Amman, and final delivery time were not verified.

Accu product code: SEBFB-M10-50-A2

3.4 Evidence and Sources

3.4.1 Accu

Product page identifies M10 × 50 mm stainless steel 18-8/304 with ISO 4017 compliance; product code SEBFB-M10-50-A2; Certificate of Conformity supplied.

- `https://accu-components.com/us/full-thread-hexagon-bolts/393090-SEBFB-M10-50-A2`
- `https://accu-components.com/us/p/1-delivery`

3.4.2 WASI GmbH

ISO 4017 A2-70 M10 × 50 mm, article 4017-2-10X50; cartons of 100, bulk pack 400.

- `https://www.wasishop.de/en/Artikeldetails.php?artikel=4017-2-10X50`

3.4.3 Keller & Kalmbach

Article 5240171050; M10 × 50 mm A2-70 ISO 4017; 3–5 month delivery indicated.

- `https://www.keller-kalmbach.com/products/fasteners/screws/hexagonal-bolts/din-933-hexagon-head-bolt/p/5240171050`

3.4.4 Schäfer + Peters

Article 4017210 50; ISO 4017 A2-70 M10 × 50 mm; 700 N/mm^2 tensile; head height 6.4 mm; SW16.

- `https://shop.schaefer-peters.com/sp/hr/iso-4017-a2-70-m-10x50-p272904/`

3.4.5 Realbolt Engineering Industries

ISO 4017 range supporting A2-70, M10 lengths 16–100 mm. Claims ISO 9001:2015 and EN 10204 3.1 reports (unverified).

- `https://real-bolt.com/standards/iso/iso-4017/`

3.5 Risks and Unverified Information

1. Availability of exactly 500 units of SEBFB-M10-50-A2.
2. Unit price, quantity discount, and total price.
3. Delivery to Amman, Jordan.
4. Shipping cost, Incoterm, customs, duties, taxes.
5. Dispatch and estimated arrival dates.

6. Batch-level material traceability for 18-8/304.
7. A2-70 classification if mechanical strength is required.
8. Certificate of Conformity referencing ISO 4017 and batch.
9. Fully threaded configuration and M10 × 1.5 coarse thread.
10. Country of origin and payment terms.

Suggested RFQ wording:

> 500 pcs, fully threaded hexagon-head screw, M10 × 50 mm, M10 × 1.5, AISI 304 stainless steel, ISO 4017, with Certificate of Conformity, delivered to Amman, Jordan.

3.6 Final Recommendation

Recommendation: Accu
Confidence: Medium

Accu provides the strongest exact product-level evidence for the requested stainless steel 304 material, M10 × 50 mm dimensions, and ISO 4017 standard. The supplier also states there is no minimum order requirement and provides a Certificate of Conformity. However, current availability for 500 units, final pricing, delivery eligibility to Amman, and final delivery date must be confirmed through a formal RFQ before the supplier can be considered fully validated.

Part II
Result B — Claude Opus 4.6

4 Supplier Research Agent: Evaluation Output (Claude Opus 4.6)

4.1 Quotation Requirements

Table 3: Quotation requirements (Claude Opus 4.6)

Requirement	Detail
Product	Stainless Steel 304 Hex Bolts
Size	M10 × 50 mm
Thread	Full thread (implied by ISO 4017)
Standard	ISO 4017 (fully threaded hex head bolt)
Material Grade	SS 304 / A2 (equivalent designations)
Quantity	500 units
Delivery Location	Amman, Jordan
Budget/Price	Not specified
Certifications	ISO 4017 compliance required

4.2 Suppliers Investigated

Table 4: Comparison of investigated suppliers (Claude Opus 4.6)

Criterion	Accu (UK)	Aspen Fasteners (USA)	FULLERKREG (China)	Hamza Fasteners (UAE)	Rebolt Alloys (India)
Product Match	Exact: M10×50 mm ISO 4017 A2 SS 304	Exact: M10×50 mm ISO 4017 A2 SS 304	Exact: M10×50 mm ISO 4017 A2-70 SS 304	General SS fasteners; no M10×50 ISO 4017 page	General SS bolts supplier
Specifications	ISO 4017, M10, 50 mm, 1.5 mm pitch, A2 SS, 6.69 mm head, natural	ISO 4017, M10, 50 mm, 1.5 mm pitch, A2 SS, 6.4 mm head	ISO 4017/DIN 933/GB 5783, A2-70 (700 MPa), SUS304, passivated	Not verified for this product	Not verified for this product
Quantity (500)	**Verified: 576 primary + 39,376 secondary**	Not verified	Not verified (bulk)	Not verified	Not verified
Certifications	CoC standard; ISO 4017 confirmed	ISO 4017 stated	MTR + ISO 3506-1 on request	ISO/ASTM mentioned	DIN/ISO/ANSI mentioned
Price (500)	**Verified: $1.86/unit ($930 total)** via API	Not verified	Not verified (contact required)	Not verified	Not verified
Delivery to Jordan	International; secondary stock lead 15 days	USA free shipping; intl not verified	China; intl available, Jordan not verified	**Confirmed Jordan export**	Claims Jordan supply
Evidence Quality	High (page + API + 54 reviews 4.83/5)	Medium (specs only)	Medium (specs only)	Low (general)	Low (general)
Overall	Best-documented match	Strong product, limited pricing	Wholesale, unverified details	Regional advantage, missing product data	Minimal verifiable data

4.3 Recommended Supplier

4.3.1 Primary Recommendation: Accu (accu-components.com)

Accu is the strongest candidate based on verified evidence:

1. **Exact product match:** M10 × 50 mm Full Thread Hex Bolt, ISO 4017, Stainless Steel A2 (304), natural finish.
2. **Verified stock:** 576 primary + 39,376 secondary.
3. **Verified volume pricing:** $1.86/unit at 500 qty (≈ $930 total), tiered pricing.
4. **Quality assurance:** Certificate of Conformity standard; ±0.13 mm tolerances.
5. **Customer trust:** 4.83/5 across 54 reviews.
6. **No MOQ** and same-day dispatch capability.

4.3.2 Secondary Recommendation: FULLERKREG

If wholesale pricing or higher-strength A2-70 is preferred: triple-standard compliance (ISO 4017 / DIN 933 / GB 5783), A2-70 (Rm ≥ 700 MPa vs A2-50 at 500 MPa), MTR + ISO 3506-1 available. Pricing and stock must be confirmed directly.

4.3.3 Regional Alternative: Hamza Fasteners

Dubai-based, confirmed export operations to Amman and across Jordan. Specific M10×50 ISO 4017 SS 304 availability must be verified.

4.4 Evidence and Sources

Table 5: Evidence and sources (Claude Opus 4.6)

Claim	Source	URL
Accu product specs	Accu product page	https://accu-components.com/us/full-thread-hexagon-bolts/393090-SEBFB-M10-50-A2
Accu pricing $1.86/unit at 500 qty	Accu stock-and-price API (XHR)	avprm34zzg.execute-api.us-east-2.amazonaws.com/Prod/stock-and-pric
Accu stock (576 + 39,376)	Accu stock-and-price API (XHR)	Same API
Accu rating 4.83/5 (54 reviews)	Bazaarvoice reviews API	Reviews JSON
Accu CoC standard	Accu product page	Same URL as above
Aspen Fasteners specs	Aspen Fasteners page	https://www.aspenfasteners.com/m10-1-5-x-50mm-iso-4017-metric-hex-head-cap-screws-bolts-full-th
FULLERKREG specs	FULLERKREG collection page	https://www.fullerkr.com/collections/full-thread-hex-bolts-iso-4017-high-tensile-stainless-steel-a2-70
Hamza Jordan delivery	Hamza Fasteners Jordan page	https://www.hamzafasteners.com/jordan/
Rebolt Jordan claims	Rebolt Fasteners page	https://reboltfasteners.com/others/stainless-steel-bolt-supplier-stockist-jordan/
Alterna Metals specs	Alterna Metals page	https://alternametals.com/stainless-steel-hex-bolt-304/m10x50
Keller & Kalmbach listing	Keller & Kalmbach page	https://www.keller-kalmbach.com/products/fasteners/screws/hexagonal-bolts/din-933-hexagon-head-bolt/p/5240171050

4.5 Risks / Unverified Information

Table 6: Risks and action items (Claude Opus 4.6)

Item	Status	Action Needed
Accu shipping cost to Jordan	Not verified	Confirm cost and carriers at checkout
Accu shipping availability to Jordan	Not verified	Confirm Accu ships to Jordan
Accu real-time stock	API data at search time	Confirm current stock before order
Accu price validity	May change	Confirm at time of order
Jordan import duties/customs	Not investigated	Buyer to verify
FULLERKREG pricing	Not verified	Contact for wholesale quote
FULLERKREG stock	Not verified	Confirm M10×50 availability
FULLERKREG Jordan delivery	Not verified	Confirm lead time from China
Hamza product specifics	Not verified	Submit size list for quote
Aspen intl shipping	Not verified	Confirm Jordan shipping
Certification validity (all)	Stated on sites	Request actual certs/MTRs
Payment terms (all)	Not verified	Confirm methods and terms
Lead time for 500 units	Partially known (Accu 15 d)	Confirm before ordering

4.6 Final Recommendation

Recommendation: Accu (accu-components.com)
Confidence: High

Accu is the strongest candidate because it offers the exact product match (M10 × 50 mm, ISO 4017, A2/304 SS, full thread) with verified stock of 576 units in primary stock — enough to fulfill the entire 500-unit order

immediately. The volume pricing of $1.86 per unit at 500 qty (total ≈ $930) is confirmed via their live pricing API, and every order includes a Certificate of Conformity as standard, directly addressing the ISO 4017 compliance requirement. The product has a strong customer reputation (4.83/5 across 54 reviews), and the company offers no minimum order quantity with same-day dispatch. The primary risk that must be confirmed is whether Accu ships internationally to Amman, Jordan, and the associated shipping cost — if this is confirmed, Accu is the clear best choice. As a fallback, Hamza Fasteners in Dubai offers a regional advantage with proven Jordan delivery infrastructure.

Part III
Result C — Gemini Flash 3.8

5 Supplier Research Agent: Evaluation Output (Gemini Flash 3.8)

5.1 Quotation Requirements

Table 7: Quotation requirements (Gemini Flash 3.8)

Criterion	Requirement
Product	Hexagon head bolts (fully threaded per standard)
Material / Grade	Stainless Steel 304 (equivalent to A2 / A2-70 / 18-8 stainless steel)
Dimensions / Size	M10 diameter × 50 mm length (thread pitch: standard metric coarse 1.5 mm)
Standard / Compliance	ISO 4017 (hexagon head screws / fully threaded bolts). **Note:** M10 width across flats is 16 mm under ISO 4017 vs. 17 mm under legacy DIN 933
Quantity	500 units
Delivery Destination	Amman, Jordan
Quality / Documentation	ISO 4017 compliance; Certificate of Conformity / Material Test Certificate recommended
Pricing / Lead Time	Best commercially viable supply and shipping terms to Amman

5.2 Suppliers Investigated

Table 8: Comparison of investigated suppliers (Gemini Flash 3.8)

Supplier	Product Match	Specifications	Quantity	Certifications	Price	Delivery	Overall Assessment
Accu Limited (UK / Global)	Exact match	M10 × 50 mm, full thread, A2/SS 304, ISO 4017 (Part SEBFB-M10-50-A2, 16 mm AF)	500 units supported (no MOQ)	CoC standard; ISO 9001 certified	Unit price tier dependent (≈£0.60–£1.10/ea; Not verified exact)	Worldwide express via UPS/FedEx to Amman. Rest of World ≈3 business days, from £34.95 + £2.00/kg	**Strongest candidate:** true ISO 4017 geometry (16 mm AF), CoC, express Jordan logistics
Hamza Fasteners (Regional / Amman)	Partial / candidate match	Hex bolts SS304/SS316, standard metric sizes (M10 × 50 mm on order)	Bulk supplier; 500 units readily met	Factory test certs & datasheets on bulk export	Price on Request / RFQ (Not verified)	Direct delivery to Amman (Zarqa & Sahab)	Good regional candidate; ISO 4017 stock & price need RFQ
Aspen Fasteners (USA / Global)	Exact match	M10-1.5 × 50 mm ISO 4017, A2-70 (SS 304), hex head cap screw (Part ME503)	500 units supported	ISO 4017 confirmed; CoC on request (Not verified)	Bulk carton pricing on site (Not verified)	Ships intl (US→Jordan via FedEx/DHL); cost Not verified	Viable alternative; slower/costlier from North America
Bossard Group (Global)	Partial match	Metric hex screws SS A2 (BN 503 / BN 31103)	Large industrial packaging / 500+	ISO 9001, ISO 14001, full traceability	Contract / RFQ only (Not verified)	Intl logistics; ME via freight/distribution (Not verified)	Viable B2B alternative; enterprise-oriented, ISO head width "on request"

5.3 Recommended Supplier

Recommended Supplier: Accu Limited

Why Accu Limited is the best match:

1. **Precise technical compliance to ISO 4017:** The primary technical hurdle with M10 hex bolts is that standard DIN 933 specifies a 17 mm width across flats (wrench size), whereas **ISO 4017 mandates 16 mm**. Accu manufactures and stocks the exact ISO 4017 specification (Product Code `SEBFB-M10-50-A2`: 16 mm socket size, tolerance +0/–0.43 mm, thread pitch 1.5 mm, full thread, A2/304 stainless steel), eliminating fitment and compliance issues.
2. **Quality documentation:** Accu provides a Certificate of Conformity as standard with their precision fasteners.
3. **Transparent logistics to Amman:** Accu operates a dedicated global shipping pipeline with integrated international tracked couriers (FedEx and UPS Express) delivering to "Rest of World" destinations including Jordan within ≈3–5 working days.
4. **Order volume match:** Accu carries stock from single units up to thousands with tiered pricing, making 500 units an off-the-shelf order.

5.4 Evidence and Sources

1. **Accu Limited — Product Page & Technical Datasheet**:
   - `https://accu-components.com/us/full-thread-hexagon-bolts/393090-SEBFB-M10-50-A2`
   - Confirms M10 × 50 mm, Stainless Steel A2 (304), ISO 4017, 16 mm socket size, full thread, standard CoC.
2. **Accu Limited — International Delivery & Rates**:
   - `https://www.accu.co.uk/p/1-delivery-rates`
   - Global courier via UPS Express / FedEx. Rest of World express transit ≈3 working days, from £34.95 + £2.00/kg.
3. **Aspen Fasteners — Product Specification Data**:
   - `https://www.aspenfasteners.com/m10-1-5-x-50mm-iso-4017-metric-hex-head-cap-screws-bolts-full-th`
   - Product ME503 matches M10-1.5 × 50 mm full thread, A2/304 SS, ISO 4017, across flats 16 mm (15.73–16.00 mm).
4. **Hamza Fasteners — Regional Distribution (Amman)**:
   - `https://www.hamzafasteners.com/jordan/`
   - Regional supplier exporting to Amman and Zarqa/Sahab industrial zones.
5. **Bossard Group — Engineering Catalog**:
   - `https://www.bossard.com/eshop/th-en/screws/screws-and-bolts-with-external-drive/hex-head-screws-p/503/`
   - Notes difference between DIN 933 and ISO 4017 (ISO wrench size 16 mm for M10 provided on request).

5.5 Risks / Unverified Information

- **Customs duties & import taxes in Jordan:** Shipments entering Jordan are subject to local customs clearance, import tariffs, and Jordanian Sales Tax (GST/VAT). Courier charges paid to Accu cover transit only; local clearance fees must be confirmed with Jordanian Customs or the local courier agent (FedEx/UPS Amman).
- **Live unit price for 500 units:** Bulk tier pricing on Accu fluctuates with exchange rates and metal surcharges; the final order total should be generated in the basket prior to issuing a PO.
- **Local alternative availability:** While Hamza Fasteners delivers directly inside Amman, whether they have 500 units of *strict* ISO 4017 (16 mm AF) vs. common DIN 933 (17 mm AF) in local stock is *Not verified* and would require an RFQ.

5.6 Final Recommendation

Recommendation: Accu Limited (Product Code: `SEBFB-M10-50-A2`)
Confidence: High

Accu explicitly confirms exact compliance with the ISO 4017 standard (specifically the critical 16 mm across-flats dimension for M10, rather than the DIN 933 standard) in 304/A2 stainless steel. They supply a standard Certificate of Conformity for quality assurance and maintain express courier delivery routes directly into Amman, Jordan via FedEx/UPS.

Part IV
Cross-Model Comparison

6 Head-to-Head Comparison: GPT-5.6 vs. Claude Opus 4.6 vs. Gemini Flash 3.8

6.1 Summary Table

Table 9: Head-to-head comparison across all three models

Dimension	GPT-5.6 (A)	Claude Opus 4.6 (B)	Gemini Flash 3.8 (C)
Recommended Supplier	Accu	Accu	Accu Limited
Confidence Level	Medium	High	High
Suppliers Investigated	5	5	4
Supplier Roster	Accu, WASI, Keller & Kalmbach, Schäfer + Peters, Realbolt	Accu, Aspen, FULLERKREG, Hamza, Rebolt	Accu, Hamza, Aspen, Bossard
Supplier Overlap	Accu only	Accu only	Accu + Aspen + Hamza
Pricing Found	No	**Yes: $1.86/unit (≈$930)**	Partial: £0.60–£1.10 range (unverified)
Stock Verified	No	**Yes: 576 + 39,376**	No (states 500 supported, no MOQ)
Shipping Cost to Jordan	Not verified	Not verified	**Partial: £34.95 + £2.00/kg from**
ISO 4017 nuance (16 vs 17 mm AF)	Terminology caveat only	Not raised	**Explicit 16 mm AF vs DIN 933 17 mm**
Source Quality	Official product pages	Pages + XHR/API + review API	Product pages + delivery rate page
Jordan Delivery	Not verified	Partial (Hamza confirms)	Partial (Accu RoW express + Hamza)
Format Adherence	Strict	Slight deviation (extras added)	Includes all required sections
Risk Handling	10-item list	Status + Action-Needed table	3-item focused list (duties, price, local alt)
Final Supplier Match	Accu	Accu	Accu

Bottom line. All three models converge on **Accu** as the recommended supplier, which is a strong signal of convergent validity across independent systems. The differentiation is in *how* they justify it.